

Seek Wander

Brand Guidelines & Marketing Strategy

Classification: CONFIDENTIAL — ZenithAI Data Room

Document Version: 1.0

Last Updated: March 2026

The definitive reference for brand identity, visual standards, tone of voice, and marketing strategy. All product, editorial, and growth decisions must be evaluated against the standards defined herein.

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01

Brand Positioning & Core Identity

The Archetype: The Ultimate Digital Concierge

Seek Wander occupies a singular position in the travel category: it is not a booking engine, not a review aggregator, and emphatically not a chatbot. It is a **digital concierge** — the invisible, impeccably-informed companion that curates a complete, opinionated luxury itinerary for a discerning traveller in under sixty seconds.

The aesthetic reference point is deliberate and non-negotiable: **Vogue meets National Geographic**. The editorial authority of Condé Nast. The geographic authority of National Geographic. Combined into a product that looks and feels like it was designed by the art department of a luxury print magazine, not a Silicon Valley startup.

"Affluent travellers do not want more options — they want fewer, better ones. The anxiety of infinite choice is the enemy of the luxury experience. Seek Wander's entire value proposition is the confident, opinionated elimination of that anxiety."

Target Demographics

Segment	Profile	Seek Wander Value
The Affluent Escapist	HHI \$200k+, 35-55, 4-6 international trips/year, 5-star properties	Eliminates planning overhead; validates instincts with editorial authority
The Luxury Digital Nomad	Location-independent, \$80k-\$150k, values experience over possessions	Rapid destination research; shareable itineraries as social currency
The Occasion Traveller	Anniversary, honeymoon, milestone — once-in-a-decade, budget unconstrained	High emotional stakes demand trusted curation, not crowdsourced opinions
The Corporate Traveller	Bleisure extension, 2-3 free days post-conference	Fast, high-quality options with zero research burden

Competitive Positioning

Competitor	Their Category	Seek Wander's Differentiation
TripAdvisor	Crowdsourced reviews	Editorial curation — one authoritative voice, not 10,000 conflicting ones
Google Travel	Utility / search	Aesthetic + narrative — a dossier, not a search result
ChatGPT	Raw AI output	Purpose-built luxury UI; enriched with live data; no prompt engineering required
Airbnb Experiences	Booking platform	Zero commercial bias — recommendations curated, not paid placements
Conde Nast Traveller	Editorial media	Interactive and personalised — the magazine curates your trip, not a generic one

The Brand Promise

"Every journey, curated with the care of a private travel consultant who has been everywhere you want to go."

Visual Guidelines — The Million-Dollar UI/UX

Design Philosophy

Every pixel of the Seek Wander interface must pass a single editorial test: **would this feel at home in a luxury print publication?** The reference documents are Kinfolk, Monocle, and Condé Nast Traveller — not app stores. The consequence is a set of non-negotiable design constraints that differentiate the product from every generic SaaS travel tool on the market.

Color Palette — Paper and Ink

The palette is derived from the physical materials of luxury print: warm paper stock, carbon ink, and restrained accent colours that signal status without shouting.

	paper Primary backgrounds — warm off-white, never pure white	#F5F0E8		paper-dark Card surfaces, input backgrounds, subtle depth	#EDE8DC		ink Primary text, borders, wordmark	#0A0A0A
	ink-light Secondary text, captions, metadata	#6B6B6B		emerald-accent Links, active states, OPEN status	#059669		burnt-orange Primary CTAs, active tab indicator, CLOSED status	#C2410C

Critical rules: paper (#F5F0E8) is the default page background — never pure white. burnt-orange is reserved exclusively for primary actions — never decorative. No gradients, no drop shadows, no glassmorphism.

Typography

Role	Font Family	Usage Rules
Display headings	Cormorant Garamond, serif	Italic, massive scale (48-96px), tight leading (0.9-1.0), editorial opener text
UI headings	Cormorant Garamond, serif	H1-H3, bold or semi-bold, generous tracking
Body & UI	DM Sans, sans-serif	All body copy, navigation, buttons, labels — never italic in UI
Micro-copy	DM Sans, sans-serif	UPPERCASE, letter-spacing: 0.2em — category labels, nav items

Component Rules — Non-Negotiable

- Shape:** border-radius: 0 on every component — buttons, cards, inputs, modals, images. No pill buttons, no rounded badges, no soft corners anywhere.
- Motion:** Framer Motion on all sections. Entrance: opacity 0 → 1, y 24 → 0, duration 0.6s easeOut. Stagger children at 0.1s. Tab transitions: y:8 in / y:-8 out, duration 0.35s.
- Photography:** All images grayscale by default (filter: grayscale(100%)). Transition to full colour on hover over 700ms. This is the editorial magazine reveal effect.
- Spacing:** Generous whitespace is mandatory. Section padding minimum py-24 (96px vertical). Never compress layouts — cut content instead.
- Borders:** Hairline only: border border-black/5 or border-b border-ink/20. No box shadows. Dividers at border-ink/10.
- Copy rule:** Never use 'AI' anywhere in UI, page titles, metadata, or marketing. The product is positioned around the outcome, never the technology.

Tone & Voice — Copywriting Lexicon

The Voice: Understated Confidence

Seek Wander speaks the way a world-travelled private member's club concierge speaks to a returning guest: with authority, warmth, and zero filler. It does not exclaim. It does not beg. It does not use power words borrowed from SaaS growth marketing.

"The three-word brief: Confident. Understated. Specific."

Core Voice Principles

Specificity over superlatives

Never say "the best restaurants." Say "a kaiseki counter with a six-month waitlist." Specificity signals insider knowledge. Superlatives signal a generic listicle.

Declarative over interrogative

Never ask the user what they want — the product already knows. Avoid "What kind of trip are you looking for?" Replace with "Tell us your destination. We'll handle the rest."

Restraint over enthusiasm

Excitement is vulgar at the luxury price point. Replace "You're going to love this!" with silence — let the quality of the itinerary speak for itself.

Editorial authority

Write every line as if it appeared in a Conde Nast publication. Every recommendation is considered. Every word is chosen. Nothing is filler.

Use This / Not That — Copywriting Lexicon

Use This	Not That	Reason
Curation	Generation / Creation	Generation signals AI machinery; Curation signals editorial judgment
Journey	Trip / Vacation	Journey implies significance and intentionality
Itinerary	Plan / Schedule	Itinerary is luxury travel vocabulary; plan is logistics vocabulary
Complimentary	Free	Free is a discount word; complimentary is a hospitality word
Dossier	Document / PDF	A dossier is what a private concierge or intelligence firm prepares
Curated by Seek Wander	Generated by AI	Never mention the technology; only the outcome
Your concierge	The app / The tool	Anthropomorphise the service; dehumanise the technology
Discover	Find / Search	Discover implies revelation; find implies a search engine
Tailored	Personalised / Custom	Personalised is SaaS; tailored is Savile Row
We recommend	You might like / Suggested	Authority over suggestion
Archive this journey	Save trip	Archive implies permanence and value; save implies a utility action

Use This	Not That	Reason
Share your dossier	Share your itinerary	Dossier elevates the object being shared

Sample Copy by Context

Landing page hero:

"The journeys you deserve, curated."

Not: AI-powered travel planning for everyone.

Empty state (/trips):

"Your journeys begin here. Every itinerary your concierge curates is archived here."

Not: You have no saved trips yet.

Save button:

"Archive this journey"

Not: Save trip

Error state:

"Your concierge encountered an unexpected interruption. Please try again."

Not: Something went wrong.

04

Zero-CAC Acquisition Engine

The Seek Wander growth model is built on a single principle: every piece of infrastructure we build should also be a distribution channel. The application generates the marketing content. The database drives the SEO. The AI writes the social copy. Customer acquisition cost approaches zero as the system matures.

Channel 1 — Programmatic SEO

Static Next.js pages generated for high-intent luxury travel search queries, sourced directly from the PlaceCache table — every destination ever generated becomes a candidate landing page automatically.

URL structure:

```
/destinations/[slug]
/destinations/amalfi-coast-luxury-itinerary
/destinations/kyoto-3-day-luxury-guide
/destinations/maldives-overwater-villa-itinerary
```

Next.js implementation:

```
generateStaticParams() reads PlaceCache → builds static pages at deploy time
Each page: editorial hero (Google Places photo) + Claude-generated editorial
           + 1-day sample timeline + single CTA: 'Curate Your Complete Journey'
```

SEO target keywords:

```
'[destination] luxury itinerary'
'[destination] 3-day luxury travel guide'
'[destination] private concierge itinerary'
```

Compounding moat: As PlaceCache grows with every generation, indexable destination pages grow automatically. By month 12, the site could have 500+ indexed luxury travel landing pages with zero additional editorial effort.

Channel 2 — Automated Social Content Engine (n8n)

n8n cloud instance triggered daily via Vercel Cron (GET /api/cron/social, 09:00 UTC). Queries the most-generated destination, generates an editorial caption via Claude, and posts to Pinterest and Twitter/X.

n8n Workflow — Daily Social Post:

```
Step 1: Vercel Cron → POST /api/cron/social (SOCIAL_CRON_SECRET header)
Step 2: Webhook node receives trigger
Step 3: Supabase Query — top destination last 7 days
        SELECT destination, COUNT(*) FROM CostLog
        WHERE createdAt > NOW() - INTERVAL '7 days'
        GROUP BY destination ORDER BY COUNT DESC LIMIT 1
Step 4: Anthropic node — generate editorial caption (240 chars, Vogue tone, no hashtags)
Step 5: POST → Pinterest Boards API (PlaceCache photo + destination slug URL)
Step 6: POST → Twitter/X API v2 (caption + /destinations/[slug] link)
Step 7: Error handler → Slack alert on failure
```

Sample output caption:

```
'Three days in Kyoto, and you haven't seen the real city yet.
The tourists leave Fushimi Inari by noon. That's when it becomes yours.'
```

Pinterest strategy: Pinterest has a 4-6 month content decay curve — a pin posted today continues driving traffic for half a year. Luxury travel is Pinterest's second-largest category. A single viral pin can drive 50,000+ monthly impressions at zero marginal cost.

Channel 3 — Referral via Shared Dossiers

Every /shared/[id] page is a public, SEO-indexable URL with full OG metadata. Every user share creates a branded acquisition touchpoint. The recipient lands on a Seek Wander page with: acquisition CTA banner, mobile sticky burnt-orange CTA button, and the full itinerary as social proof of the product quality.

05

User Lifecycle & White-Glove Retention

The Onboarding Philosophy

The first 10 minutes after sign-up are the highest-leverage retention window in the entire user lifecycle. Most SaaS products waste this window with an automated HTML email template featuring a logo, three feature bullets, and a 'Get Started' button that nobody clicks. Seek Wander's onboarding is built around a single, radical constraint: **it must feel like a human sent it.**

The Automated Founder's Welcome

Trigger: Clerk user.created webhook → POST /api/webhooks/clerk → verified via svix → n8n webhook with user email and first_name.

n8n Workflow – Founder's Welcome:

```
Step 1: Webhook receives { email, firstName, userId }
Step 2: Wait node – 10 minutes
      (User has had time to generate their first itinerary)
Step 3: Supabase Query – check if user has generated >= 1 trip
      If yes: personalise copy with destination name
      If no: use generic welcome variant
Step 4: Send Email via Resend
      From:    roman@seekwander.com
      Reply-To: roman@seekwander.com
      Subject: Your first journey
      Format:  Plain text ONLY – no HTML, no logo, no unsubscribe footer
```

Email copy (destination-aware variant):

```
Hi [firstName],

I wanted to reach out personally. You just curated your first journey
to [destination] with Seek Wander, and I'm genuinely grateful you gave
it a try.

Seek Wander isn't a search engine. Every itinerary is considered with
the same care a private travel consultant gives a long-standing client.
Hidden restaurants. The museum room nobody queues for. The hotel that
doesn't advertise.

If you have feedback, a dream destination, or just want to tell me what
we got right or wrong – reply here. I read every email.

Warmly,
Roman
Founder, Seek Wander
```

Why plain text: HTML emails are immediately recognisable as automated. A plain-text email from roman@seekwander.com with no logo, no CTA button, and no unsubscribe footer reads as a personal message from a founder. Open rates for this format consistently reach 60-80% versus 20-25% for HTML equivalents.

Retention Touchpoints

Touchpoint	Trigger	Channel	Goal
Founder's Welcome	Sign-up + 10 min	Email (plain text)	Establish personal relationship with founder
Journey Archived	Trip saved	In-app toast	Reinforce value of the save action
Share Prompt	After generation	In-app modal	Viral referral loop via shared dossier
Programmatic SEO	Organic search	Web / Google	Top-of-funnel re-acquisition
Social Pin	Daily cron (09:00)	Pinterest / Twitter	Brand awareness + SEO backlinks

Monetization Aesthetics

The Inviolable Rule: No Display Advertising

Seek Wander will never run display advertising. Banner ads, sponsored content labels, affiliate badges, 'Ad' markers, and interstitials are categorically incompatible with the luxury brand positioning.

"The moment a user sees a banner ad on Seek Wander, the brand becomes indistinguishable from TripAdvisor. The trust that justifies acting on a Seek Wander recommendation — which is the entire monetization thesis — is instantly destroyed. All revenue must be invisible at the point of experience."

Revenue Stream 1 — Native Affiliate Placements

The concierge model: A luxury hotel concierge who books a restaurant for a guest receives a referral fee. The guest never sees the transaction. The recommendation is trusted because it is excellent — the fee is irrelevant to its quality. This is the exact model Seek Wander applies.

In-UI rendering (TimelineCard):

```
[TimelineCard – Le Bernardin, New York]

  Michelin three-star French cuisine...      <- AI-generated description
  DINNER | $$$$ | Reservation recommended  <- metadata badges
  Reserve a table ->                        <- affiliate link (OpenTable)
                                           DM Sans 8pt, ink-light colour
                                           Indistinguishable from concierge copy
```

Affiliate partners and commission structure:

Partner	Category	Commission	Est. Revenue per Booking
Booking.com	Hotels & accommodation	4-6% of booking value	\$120-180 on a \$3,000 night
Viator	Tours & experiences	8% of booking value	\$32-80 on a \$400-1,000 tour
GetYourGuide	Activities	8-10% of booking value	\$24-50 on a \$300-500 activity
OpenTable	Restaurant reservations	\$1-2 per seated cover	\$2-8 per table of 2-4

Revenue at scale: At 1,000 monthly active users with a 15% hotel booking conversion rate and average booking value of \$2,000, affiliate commissions represent \$12,000-18,000 MRR with zero marginal cost per transaction.

Revenue Stream 2 — Stripe Paywall (Deprioritized)

Status: Architecture complete, implementation deprioritized pending affiliate revenue validation. The affiliate model has higher lifetime value per user with zero conversion friction. A \$4.99 gate reduces top-of-funnel conversion by an estimated 60-80% at the pre-brand-awareness stage.

UI approach when implemented: Stripe Checkout triggered via a custom luxury modal — not a redirect. The modal uses paper background (#F5F0E8), Cormorant Garamond heading ('Unlock Your Journey'), and a single burnt-orange button. Designed to feel like a membership application, not a payment form.

Legal Disclosure Requirements

All affiliate link placements must include a passive disclosure per FTC guidelines and affiliate programme terms of service:

- **Per-itinerary footer:** 'Seek Wander may earn a commission on bookings made through links in this itinerary. Our recommendations are never influenced by commercial relationships.'
- **Privacy Policy:** Must reference affiliate data collection (click tracking, booking attribution).
- **Terms of Service:** Must reference the nature of affiliate relationships and that recommendations are editorially independent.

This document defines the non-negotiable brand standards for Seek Wander. All product, marketing, and editorial decisions must be evaluated against the single test: does this belong in a luxury print publication? If not, it does not belong in Seek Wander.